

you going to be tasting more than any other, and allocate more of your food dollar to that item. If the salad is just a side dish, the iceberg might work, but if the salad's going to be your main course, go with a lettuce with more texture, more bulk, and more flavor."

4. Kalamata olives

These are just delish. I like to eat them straight out of the container, but Michele Samuels, a public relations consultant, has some even better ideas. She uses them to adorn salads, enhance a pasta sauce, dress up sandwiches, and garnish potato salads!

5. Capers

Seriously? I didn't even know what a caper was before I worked in a restaurant. After I learned of the odd little ingredient, however, I was hooked! Michele also loves the tiny flower buds, using them atop bagels and cream cheese and egg salads.



6. Dried beans

When you sacrifice convenience, you are often rewarded with flavor and savings! According to Anna Broadway, author of *Sexless in the City* (and a writer who spent nearly two years in Brooklyn eating on \$50/week or less for food and transit), soaking and cooking them yourself will take extra time, but a 1 lb. bag of dried beans is a better buy. There is also a marked improvement in the flavor of the beans.

7. Sun-dried tomatoes

Many foodies claim that adding a few will bring impressive flavor to any dish. Former blogger Steve Bertasso dries his own, adding that the surplus of last season's fresh tomatoes are perfect as a dried ingredient in pastas, meats, and breads.

8. A ball of whole-milk mozzarella

This creamy alternative to prepackaged, already-shredded mozzarella comes recommended. The higher fat